

Sentinels of the Dawn

Newsletter of the Poor Clares of Perpetual Adoration
Monastere Notre Dame des Anges
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Urbain IV-
the Pope from Troyes who instituted Corpus Christi



Under the sunny skies of Saturday, May 8th, the heart of the city of Troyes found its streets filled with a flood of young people. The diocese had organized a vocation rally for this festive day, on which Rémi Prud'hom was to be ordained a priest that afternoon in the Cathedral. More than 25 groups of youth journeyed from church to church, plaza to plaza, where they discovered the life of men and women in the life of the Church in Troyes, those of the past and the present.

Sister Margaret Mary and Sister Faustina Marie from our Monastery had the great joy of welcoming five different groups of youth at the Basilica of St Urbain. There, our Sisters presented the life of a native of Troyes, Jacques Pantaléon, who later became Pope Urbain IV. Some time after his election to the Holy See, he returned to his beloved native city with the desire of having a Church built in honor of his patron, Urbain I, pope and martyr. The location he chose was the exact area where his father worked as a shoemaker and the neighborhood where he passed his childhood days. The edification of this magnificent work of art would encounter several roadblocks before the dawn of its completion six centuries later! Pope Urbain IV is perhaps best known for having inaugurated the great feast of Corpus Christi.



Interestingly enough, 600 years after Pope Urbain IV instituted Corpus Christi as a universal feast in the Church, our Order of Poor Clares was founded and took root in Troyes. Both of our Founders, Father Bonaventure Herlaut and Mother Marie de Saint Claire were born in the diocese of Troyes. Like Pope Urbain IV, they too shared the same desire to honor Jesus in the Most Blessed Sacrament, so they chose Eucharistic adoration in a spirit of thanksgiving as the central purpose of our Order.



The second half of the Sisters' presentation informed the youth about our life as adorers of the Blessed Sacrament, which like a flame, has been passed on from one generation to the next, from France to many different countries throughout the world.

Our prayer is that some "seeds" of faith were planted in the hearts of those who were introduced to our way of life. May they one day also be a part of the rich history of the Church in Troyes through the particular vocation that God has chosen for each of them.

Adoration – A Necessity for our Time

From May 16th through the 22nd, the 16th National Eucharistic Congress was held in Brazil. In the motto of the Congress, *Stay with us, Lord*, we find the words of the disciples of Emmaus. This motto is "an expression of the desire that beats in the heart of every human being," Pope Benedict XVI stated. He added that "It is in the Most Holy Sacrament of the altar where Jesus shows his will to be with us, to live with us, to give himself to us." Benedict XVI explained further that "adoration leads us to recognize the primacy of God, as He can transform men's hearts, raising them to union with Christ in only one Body," to the point that "we experience communion with a Love that we cannot keep for ourselves: it calls for being communicated to others so as to be able to build a more just society." In light of this event, as well as other times when our Holy Father has stressed the need for silent adoration of Jesus concealed in the Host, let us look more closely at its beauty and necessity in today's world.

A = Act of Love

Adoration is a time of intimate prayer with the Lord, a heart to heart conversation with Him who knows all our needs. Sometimes a simple gaze upon Jesus in the Host suffices. Sometimes no words are needed, only an act of faith, believing that He is truly present – Body, Blood, Soul and Divinity – although our human eyes see only an appearance of bread. "I look at Him and He looks at me," was the simple response of one of the Cure of Ars parishoners, when questioned how he spent his long and numerous times in adoration. Mother Teresa of Calcutta enlightens us further in relating: "When we look at the cross, we know how much Jesus loved us. When we look at the tabernacle or the monstrance, we know how much Jesus loves us now".

D = Day and Night

"We adore Thee, O Christ, and we bless Thee, here and in all the tabernacles of the world, because by Thy Holy Cross Thou has redeemed the world." (Prayer of St. Francis of Assisi) What an amazing reality: Jesus is present in every tabernacle of every Church throughout the world! He makes Himself so accesible to each one of us. And more importantly, Jesus waits for us in this sacrament of love. Perpetual adoration in the Eucharist is a sublime expression of our love for Jesus, who loves us so much that He does not want to leave us; this is why He has promised to remain with us until the end of time in the Blessed Sacrament. "With an eternal love I have loved thee. My love for you is constant" (Jer. 31:3).

O=Orate

Orate means "to pray" in Latin. Why pray? Jesus frequently went off by himself to pray – in the desert, up on the mountains, to be alone with his Father, to communicate with his Father privately to pray quietly, to worship, to thank, to ask for help and strength, especially before major events and decisions in His life. Jesus prayed in private for forty days in the desert before beginning His public ministry. Again, before he chose the twelve apostles from among his disciples, Jesus spent the whole night in private prayer. The night before he died, Jesus prayed alone to his Father asking for the strength to bear the suffering that He would undergo the next day.

We, too, should follow this example of Jesus. Prayer before the Holy Eucharist is a source of strength for us, especially in times of difficulty and hardship. He enlightens the heart and the mind, revealing His Holy Will. Prayer is that fuel that keeps our minds and hearts fixed on the ultimate goal – the Kingdom to come.

R= Remain with us

"He is there", the Holy Curé of Ars would exclaim as he stared at the tabernacle. He was a man of the Eucharist which he celebrated and adored; "There is no reality greater than the Eucharist", he used to affirm. What touched him most deeply perhaps was the realisation that God was there, for us, present in the tabernacle : "He awaits us !" The awareness of the real presence of God in the Blessed Sacrament was perhaps one of his greatest graces and one of his greatest joys. Giving God to men and men to God in the Eucharistic sacrifice became the heart of his day and of his priestly ministry.

Jesus chose this very special way to remain with us. It was not just an empty promise when Jesus said, "I will be with you all days, even to the end of the world". He meant that! Jesus remains here with us today in the Mass as our Savior, in Holy Communion as our spiritual food, and in the tabernacle as our friend.

E = Eternity

In the Blessed Sacrament we receive a foretaste of eternal happiness and peace. Only a thin veil separates us from the beauty of Him whom we shall see face to face forever in Eternity. What we do presently before His Divine Presence in the Blessed Sacrament - gaze upon Him, adore Him, love Him, thank Him, sing His praises – we shall do forever in Heaven. Let us begin now !

The Year for Priests: Rekindling the Gift

God makes use of us poor men in order to be, on their behalf. This audacity of God who weaknesses, nonetheless considers men capable God is the true grandeur concealed in the word that in this way he calls men to his service and wanted to reflect upon and appreciate anew over at how close God is to us, and our gratitude for the and sustains us daily.

through us, present to all men and women, and to act entrusts himself to human beings – who, conscious of our of acting and being present in his stead – this audacity of "priesthood". That God thinks that we are capable of this; thus from within binds himself to them: this is what we the course of the past year. We wanted to reawaken our joy fact that he entrusts himself to our infirmities; that he guides

- Benoît XVI: Mass for the Conclusion of the Year for Priests, June 11, 2010

The Solemnity of the Sacred Heart on June 11th marked the closing of the Year for Priests. It has been a time of great grace, of suffering and purification, not only for priests, but also for the entire Church. We wish at the close of this year to express once again our gratitude to all priests throughout the worldwho by their lives and ministry lead us to God.



Thank you, Lord, for priests, who inspire us by their words and their lives.

Thank you, Lord, for priests, who listen and counsel us, sometimes at our worst moments.

Thank you, Lord, for priests, who offer us your forgiveness in the sacrament of reconciliation, where the words "I absolve you from your sins" heal our wounded souls and restore us to grace.

Thank you, Lord, for priests, who give us the most precious gift of the Holy Eucharist. Mere bread is transformed into your Body, Blood, Soul and Divinity. You are present on our altars and in the tabernacles of all Churches throughout the world. We are nourished with this heavenly food, as each passing day brings us closer to Eternity.

Thank you, Lord, for this Year for Priests, this privileged period of prayer and reflection on the priesthood. May each priest continue his mission in the Church and in the world with renewed joy and with the conviction that God loves, strengthens and feeds His people through them.

May the Virgin Mary, Mother and Queen of Priests, intercede for them and inspire them in the following of her Son Jesus Christ, our Lord.



You are a Priest Forever

During this year of Priests, we give thanks for all seminarians who were ordained to the priesthood. Our diocese is particularly grateful for the ordination of Father Rémi Prud'hom on the 8th of May. Our Community had the privilege of welcoming him to our chapel, where he celebrated Mass a few days later. We thank Father for responding to the call of Christ, and for his ministry in the Church, through which he will draw others to Him who is the Way, the Truth and the Life.

A Prayer for Priests

Lord Jesus, with Saint John Marie Vianney, we confide to you all priests, priests whom we know, those whom we have encountered, those who have helped us, those whom you have given us today as "Fathers" .

You have called each one by name; for each one we thank you and we beg you to keep them faithful in your name. You who have consecrated them so that in your name, they may be our pastors, give them strenth, confidence and joy to accomplish their mission.

May the Eucharist that they celebrate nourish them and give them the courage to offer themelves with you for us, who are the flock they shepherd. May they be immersed in your Merciful Heart so that they may always be witnesses of your forgiveness. May they be true adorers of the Father so that they will teach us the true path to holiness.

Father, with them, we offer ourselves to Christ for the Church. May it be missionary through the breath of your Spirit. Teach us simply to love and respect them, and to receive them as a gift which comes from your hand, so that together we may better accomplish your work for the salvation of all. Amen.

-Prayer from the Sanctuary of Ars, France





Three years after our departure from Castelnaudary, our Community had the delight of being reunited with Sister Marie Edwige. Journeying to a Carmelite monastery in the northwest part of France, where she was to attend to some community business, God's providence permitted her to pass through Troyes. We were happy to welcome her for an overnight visit. Our time together passed too quickly, but we give thanks for the blessings and graces of this joyful occasion.

Saint Anthony is best known as the patron of lost things. He "found" his new home among us a short time ago. In celebrating his feast day on June 13th, we express a special thanks to the Poor Clares of Aix-en-Provence for offering us this beautiful statue.



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The Secret of a Greener Garden



It's that time again, when we roll up our sleeves and get our hands dirty! Gardening has become a popular summer activity within our Community. Every year we look forward to seeing the marvels of God unfold before our very eyes… not, of course, without some time and work on our part, too! One of our first outdoor projects this year was emptying our rather large compost pit where God turns what would have been mere garbage into a rich, natural fertilizer. Here are a few reasons why we have a compost heap.

·**Reduction of Waste:** Composting converts much of the "trash" that goes to landfills into a natural "treasure". Up to 75% of household garbage is derived from organic matter and most of it can be composted. Fruit and vegetables peelings, egg shells, used coffee grounds, grass clippings, etc all go into our compost .



· **Protection of the Environment:** Since compost makes such great fertilizer, it reduces the need for chemical substitutes.

· **Participation in a life-giving cycle:** What we receive from the earth that is not consumable we return to the earth, where it decays, then gives life all over again. Our compost has given us a greater awareness and respect for the natural process that God created, and an opportunity to be good stewards of the little parcel of land where we live.

· **Cost-Effectiveness:** Composting saves money. It only costs a daily trip out to the compost heap to empty the bucket!